

The Grand Canyon is a gorge carved by the Colorado River in the State of Arizona, United States. The Grand Canyon is 446/447 km, long with an average width of 6.4 to 29 km. and attains a depth of over 1.8 km.

5. Chisapani Gorge is located in –

- | | |
|----------------|--------------|
| (a) India | (b) Nepal |
| (c) Bangladesh | (d) Pakistan |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Chisapani Gorge is located in Nepal and is formed by the Karnali river. Karnali river is the longest river in Nepal measuring is 507 km long. It forms various gorges because of its swift flow.

6. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- | | |
|---------------|-----------|
| (a) Canyon | - River |
| (b) Zeugen | - Wind |
| (c) Inselberg | - Glacier |
| (d) Moraine | - Glacier |

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Canyons are formed by rivers. They take the form of a V-shaped valley, in which the side wall have a steep slope and the depth is greater than the width. Moraines are formed by the depositional action of glaciers. Glaciers transport Material ranging from fine particles to large boulders. When the glacier cannot carry away these substances, they get deposited and this deposit is called a moraine. In addition, zeugen and inselberg are produced by wind. In deserts, soft rock is easily cut away by weathering and erosion, but hard rock remains as remnants in the form of dunes, which are called inselbergs. As a result of the erosion process of the wind, in the desert shapes resembling covered feasts are formed from the rocks. Such land, forms are called 'Jurgen'. Hence, it is clear that option (c) is not correctly matched.

7. Nobi and Kanto plains are located in which of the following countries?

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| (a) North Korea | (b) South Korea |
| (c) Japan | (d) China |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

- The Nobi Plain is a large plain in Japan that stretches from the central part of Japan and is about 1800 sq. km in area.
- Kanto Plain, also spelled Kwanto Plain, Japanese Kanto-Heiya, plain that is the most extensive lowland in Japan, located in central Honshu, facing the Pacific Ocean. Its 17000 square km. contain the capital city, Tokyo, and constitute the most productive and populous area of the country.

The Islands

*An island is a piece of land surrounded on all sides by water. It may occur individually or in a group, in open oceans or seas. Smaller ones of only local significance are found even in lakes and rivers. Islands can be grouped under the following types- (a) **Continental Islands** (b) **Oceanic Islands**. ***Greenland** is the world's largest (2166086 sq. km.) island. Greenland is an autonomous constituent region of the Kingdom of Denmark. *Nuuk is the capital and the largest city of Greenland. **Nuuk** has an elevation of 1-3 m above sea level. ***New Guinea** is the second largest (785753 sq. km.) island in the world, located north of Australia. It is separated from the Australian mainland by **Torres Strait**. ***Borneo** is the third largest island in the world and the largest in Asia, located north of Java Sea. The island is politically divided among three countries- **Indonesia (73%), Malaysia (26%) and Brunei (1%)**. The Kalimantan region of Indonesia is a part of Borneo islands. ***Madagascar** is an island country located in the Southwestern Indian Ocean, off the coast of East Africa. To the east of Madagascar, we have the island country of **Mauritius** and to the west, we have the African country of **Mozambique**. Madagascar is the fourth largest (587041 sq. km.) island in the world. ***Diego Garcia** is an island in the Indian Ocean. The island is named after the Portuguese explorer Diego Garcia who discovered it in the early 16th century. From 1814 to 1965 the island was a part of colonial Mauritius, later it became a dependency of the British Colony. In 1966, the United Kingdom leased it to the United States. At present, Diego Garcia is an **active military base** far the both **US** and **UK**. ***Seychelles** is an island situated to the north of Madagascar in the Indian Ocean. The island group comprises 115 islands, some of which are made up of corals and granite. *The Chagos Islands are located in the Indian Ocean. Diego Garcia is the largest island of Chagos Archipelago. ***Mauritius** is an island nation, located to the east of Madagascar in the Indian Ocean. ***Socotra** Island is located in the Indian Ocean between 12°30' North latitude and 54° East Longitude. The island is officially a part of Yemen. * The island of Indonesia extends from Aceh in the west to Torres Strait (a Strait that lies between Australia and the Melanesian island of New Guinea) in the east. Indonesia is an island country in Southeast Asia between the Indian and Pacific Oceans. There are 17508 islands in Indonesia. Out of the 17508 islands only 1000 have been inhabited. * **Fiji** is an island country in the Pacific Ocean. Fiji lies to the east of Vanuatu, west of Tonga and the south of Tuvalu. ***Fiji** comprises 333 islands but approx. 87% of its population is concentrated on two islands **Viti Levu** and **Vanua Levu**. * The Falkland Archipelago is an Island group in South Atlantic Ocean, located at a distance of 650 km from the mainland

of South America. * The **Azores Island** are an autonomous region of Portugal. * **Cape Verde** Island and the **Bahamas** are located in the Atlantic Ocean. * **Macau** is located approx. 64 km to the west of Hong Kong and is attached to mainland China. * **Grenada** is an island country in the southeastern caribbean Sea. Grenada consists of three islands - Grenada, carriacou and Petite Martinique which form the southern end of the Windward Islands. The island is also known as '**Island of Spices**' because of the heavy production of the same. The island is located on the North Coast of Venezuela at a distance of 160 km. *The **Balearic Islands** are an archipelago of Spain in the western Mediterranean Sea. It is an autonomous community and a province of Spain. The flag of the Balearic Islands is distinct from that of Spain. The **Balearic archipelago** consists of 4 major islands. The capital of this island is Palma de Mallorca. Balearic island was a part of Spain since 1833 A.D. but in 1983 they became an autonomous region. ***Melanesia** is a sub-region of Oceania extending from Papua New Guinea in the South western Pacific Ocean to the Arafura Sea and then eastward to Fiji. The important islands of the region are- New Guinea, Bismarck Archipelago, Santa Cruz, Vanuatu, Solomon, Fiji and New Caledonia. *The Australian continent is an island continent. It is the smallest continent and is completely under the jurisdiction of the sovereign state of Australia. *Japan is located in the Pacific Ocean to the east of the Asian mainland. It is a country of about **14125** islands (at least 100m circumference) of these only four are large and important. In order of their size, they are **Honshu, Hokkaido, Kyushu** and **Shikoku**. Hokkaido is the northernmost island of Japan among these four islands and occupies an approx. area of 83453.57 km². In the middle is Honshu occupying an area of 228000 km² and in the southwestern part the islands of Kyushu and Shikoku are located. *The capital of Japan i.e. **Tokyo** is located on **Honshu** Island. ***Majuli** island is the largest river Island in the world, located in the Brahmaputra River, in the state of Assam (India).

*The **Faroe Islands** are also known as **sheep islands**. They are located to the south of Norwegian Sea in North Atlantic Ocean. It is an autonomous country of the Kingdom of Denmark. The Faroe Archipelago consists of 18 mountainous islands.

1. Which of the following islands are known as 'Sheep Islands'?

- (a) Canary Islands (b) Madeira Islands
(c) Faroe Islands (d) Wellington Islands

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Faroe Island is also known as "Sheep Island". It is a self-governing archipelago that is part of Denmark. It comprises 18 rocky and volcanic islands.

2. Which one of the following is the largest in area?

- (a) New Zealand North Island
(b) New Foundland
(c) New Zealand South Island
(d) Java

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

New Zealand South Island 150436 sq. km is the largest in the area whereas Java has an area of 138794 sq km, New Zealand North Island 114687 sq km and Newfoundland has an area of 111390 sq. km accordingly.

3. The largest Island of the World is :

- (a) Borneo (b) Greenland
(c) Madagascar (d) New Guinea

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

The largest island in the world is Greenland. The area of all above-mentioned islands is as follows:

Greenland (Denmark) - 21,66,086 sq. km

New Guinea - 785,753 sq. km.

Borneo - 751929 sq. km.

Malagasy or Madagascar - 587,041 sq. km.

4. The second largest Island of the world is :

- (a) Borneo (b) Madagascar
(c) New Guinea (d) Sumatra

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

New Guinea is the second largest (785753 sq. km) island in the world located north of Australia. World largest island is Greenland. Its area is 2,166,086 square kilometers. Madagascar is the largest island in Africa and one of the oldest geological islands on Earth.

5. The largest island (after Greenland) of the world is :

- (a) Borneo (b) Malagasy
(c) Sumatra (d) New Guinea

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which one of the following statements is correct ?

- (a) Greenland is the second largest (area) island in the World.
(b) Nuuk is a small town of Greenland.

- (c) The elevation of Nuuk above the sea level is 3 meter
(d) Greenland belongs to the U.S.A.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (c)

Greenland is the largest island in the world. Greenland belongs to Denmark. Nuuk is the capital and largest city of Greenland. The elevation of Nuuk above the sea level is 1-3 meters.

7. Greenland is a part of which one of the following countries?

- (a) Denmark (b) Finland
(c) Canada (d) United Kingdom
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Which one among the following eastern islands is divided into three countries?

- (a) Borneo (b) Celebes
(c) New Guinea (d) Timor

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Borneo is the third -largest island in the world and the largest island in Asia. The island is divided among three countries: Malaysia (26%), Brunei (1%) and Indonesia (73%).

9. Which one among the following is the largest island in area?

- (a) Borneo (b) Great Britain
(c) Madagascar (d) Sumatra
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

In the given options, Borneo's area is highest (751929 sq. km), followed by Madagascar (587041 sq. km), Sumatra (472784 sq. km) and Great Britain area (209331 sq. km).

10. With reference to Borneo Island, located in South East Asia, which of the following statements is / are true?

1. It is divided among three countries.
2. It has been formed due to volcano deposition.
Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Code :

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Only 1
(c) Neither 1 nor 2 (d) Only 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

Borneo, an island in the extreme southwestern part of the Pacific Ocean. It is the third largest island in the world, surpassed in size only by Greenland and New Guinea, Borneo is situated Southeast in Asia off the Malay Peninsula in the Greater Sunda Islands group of the Malay Archipelago. The island is divided into three countries : Indonesia (73%), Malaysia (26%), and Brunei (1%). It has been formed due to volcano deposition also. Hence option (a) is correct.

11. Kalimantan is a part of which of the following islands?

- (a) Honshu
(b) Borneo
(c) Cuba
(d) Madagascar (Malagasy)

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Kalimantan is the Indonesian portion of the island of Borneo. It comprises 73% of the island area.

12. Madagascar is the largest island in –

- (a) Indian Ocean (b) Pacific Ocean
(c) Bay of Bengal (d) Red Sea

Uttarakhand U.D.A./LDA (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

Madagascar is an island located in the south west of the Indian Ocean. Mauritius is located to its east and Mozambique to its west.

13. In the map given below, four islands of Indian Ocean region i.e., (A) Seychelles, (B) Chagos, (C) Mauritius and (D) Socotra are marked as 1, 2, 3 and 4. Match them and select the correct answer from the codes given below:



Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	4	2
(b)	3	1	2	4

- (c) 1 3 2 4
(d) 3 1 4 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (d)

The four islands of Indian Ocean indicated on the map are as follows:

Seychelles is indicated by point 3. Seychelles is completely surrounded by the **Indian Ocean**. It is located between 4° - 11° south latitude and 45° - 56° east longitude. The archipelago consists of 155 islands including some granite islands and some coral islands.

Chagos is indicated by point 1. Chagos Archipelago coordinates are 4.5° - 7.5° south latitude and 71° - 73° east longitude in the Central Indian Ocean. Diego Garcia (44 km^2) is the largest island of the Chagos Archipelago.

Mauritius is indicated by point 4. It is located at approx. 20° south latitude and 57° east longitude.

Socotra is indicated by point 2. Socotra is a part of Yemen and located at approx. $12^{\circ} 30' \text{ N}$ latitude & 54° E longitude.

14. Which one of the following islands is located in the south Indian Ocean ?

- (a) Chagos (b) Maldives
(c) Mauritius (d) Seychelles

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (*)

See the explanation of the above question. Because Chagos, Mauritius and Seychelles are also in South Indian Ocean. correct options will be (a), (c) and (d).

15. Which of the following islands of the Pacific Ocean belongs to Melanesia group of islands ?

- (a) Solomon island (b) Gilbert island
(c) Society island (d) Marshall island

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (a)

Melanesia is a sub-region of Oceania extending from the western end of the Pacific Ocean to the Arafura Sea and eastward to Fiji. The following islands and groups of islands are traditionally considered part of Melanesia :

1. Bismarck Archipelago
2. Fiji
3. New Caledonia
4. New Guinea (Country - Papua New Guinea)
5. Solomon Islands
6. Vanuatu

16. Diego Garcia is situated in -

- (a) Indian Ocean (b) Pacific Ocean
(c) Arctic Ocean (d) Atlantic Ocean

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Diego Garcia is located in the Indian Ocean. Portuguese adventurer Diego Garcia first spotted it in early 16th century. Thus, it was named after him. It was administered by Colonial Mauritius from 1814 to 1965. Later it came under the control of United Kingdom and was leased to the USA. Currently, it serves as a strategic base for both countries.

17. The distance from Aceh in the far North West to Torres Strait in the east is 5000 miles, almost equal to the distance London and Baghdad. The archipelago has 14,000 islands, some mere equatorial rocks, others some of the largest in the world." This description best fits :

- (a) West Indies (b) Japan
(c) Philippines (d) Indonesia

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

This description best fits Indonesia which stretches from Aceh in the far north-west to Torres Strait in the east. It consists of 17508 islands about 1,000 of which are inhabited.

18. Consider the map given below: The numbers marked 1, 2, 3 and 4 respectively indicate the islands of :



- (a) The Bahamas, Azores, Falkland Cape Verde
(b) The Bahamas, Azores, Cape Verde and Falkland
(c) Azores, Cape Verde, the Bahamas and Falkland
(d) Cape Verde, the Bahamas, Falkland and Azores

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The numbers marked 1, 2, 3 and 4 respectively indicate the Islands of Azores (Portugal), Cape Verde, the Bahamas and Falkland (U.K.). Thus, the correct answer is option (c).

19. Which of the following statement is not correct ?

- (a) Falkland Archipelago is located in the Indian Ocean.
- (b) Namibia is located in Africa.
- (c) Nicaragua is in Central America.
- (d) Yemen is in Asia.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

The Falkland archipelago is in South Atlantic. The main island is around 650 km. east of South American continent.

20. Fiji Island is located in –

- (a) Atlantic ocean
- (b) Pacific ocean
- (c) Indian ocean
- (d) Arabian sea

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Fiji is an island country in the South Pacific Ocean. Its closest neighbours are Vanuatu to the west, Tonga to the east and Tuvalu to the north. Fiji is an archipelago of 333 islands of which the two major islands, Viti Levu and Vanua Levu, are inhabited by 87% of the total population.

21. With reference to the 'Galapagos Islands' situated in the Pacific Ocean, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- (1) They are formed due to volcanic activity.
- (2) They are part of South American nation Peru.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (a)

The 'Galapagos Islands' located in the Pacific Ocean have originated due to volcanic activity. They are part of South American nation Ecuador.

22. Which of the following is the largest island of Japan ?

- (a) Hokkaido
- (b) Shikoku
- (c) Hodouri
- (d) Honshu

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

Japan is a group of four main islands Hokkaido, Shikoku, Kyushu & Honshu. Honshu is the largest island where capital Tokyo is situated. In these islands, Hokkaido (83,453.57 km²) is in the north and mainland Honshu (228000 km²) and Shikoku & Kyushu are situated to south-west of the archipelago.

23. The largest island of Japan in terms of the geographical area is.

- (a) Hokkaido
- (b) Honshu
- (c) Shikoku
- (d) Kyushu
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Which of the following represents the correct north to south sequence of following four islands of Japan?

- (a) Hokkaido, Honshu, Kyushu, Shikoku
- (b) Hokkaido, Shikoku, Honshu, Kyushu
- (c) Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, Kyushu
- (d) Hokkaido, Kyushu, Honshu, Shikoku

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

The correct sequence of the four islands of Japan in a north to south direction is as follows—Hokkaido—Honshu—Shikoku—Kyushu. Honshu is the largest and most populous island of Japan. The island separates the sea of Japan from the North Pacific Ocean. Hokkaido—is the second largest island of Japan. The Tsugaru Strait separates Hokkaido from Honshu. The two islands are connected by the undersea railway Seikan Tunnel. Shikoku is the smallest and least populous of the four main islands of Japan. Kyushu is the third largest island of Japan. One of Japan's most active volcanoes, Mt. Aso is on Kyushu Island.

25. Which one of the following presents the correct North-South sequence of the four major islands of Japan?

- (a) Shikoku, Kyushu, Hokkaido, Honshu
- (b) Honshu, Hokkaido, Shikoku, Kyushu
- (c) Hokkaido, Honshu, Kyushu, Shikoku
- (d) Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, Kyushu

U.P. B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

26. When was Macau island transferred to China ?

- (a) 1990
- (b) 1992
- (c) 1997
- (d) 1999

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

Macau lies to the west of Hong Kong, which is about 64 kilometers away. Macau is a small peninsula connected with mainland China. The transfer of sovereignty of Macau from the Portuguese Republic to the People's Republic of China (PRC) occurred in December 1999 under an agreement after long negotiations.

27. Where are the Balearic islands located ?

- (a) Mediterranean Sea (b) Black Sea
(c) Baltic Sea (d) North Sea

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

The Balearic Islands are an archipelago of Spain in the Western Mediterranean Sea. The Balearic Islands are an autonomous division of Spain. Balearic Islands consist of a group of 4 major island. The archipelago has Palma de Mallorca as its capital. The official languages in the Balearic Islands are Catalan and Spanish. The Balearic Islands have been part of Spain since 1833 and became autonomous in 1983.

28. On which river is the world's largest river island?

- (a) Nile (b) Amazon
(c) Brahmaputra (d) Sindh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Majuli is a river island in the Brahmaputra river (Assam). It is the largest river island in the world. Majuli became a first riverine island to be made first district in India.

29. Which of the following is an island continent ?

- (a) Africa (b) New Zealand
(c) Greenland (d) Australia

Uttarakhand U.D.A./LDA (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

Australian continent is an island continent. It is the smallest continent in the world.

30. Grenada is located in –

- (a) Pacific Ocean (b) Indian Ocean
(c) Caribbean Sea (d) Mediterranean Sea

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Grenada is an island country consisting of three islands in the southeastern Caribbean Sea. Grenada is also known as the “Island of Spice” because of the excess production of spices. It is located approx 160 km North of Venezuela.

31. Which of the following islands is known for its Salt-Pan resources?

- (a) Isle of Man
(b) Saint-Martin Island
(c) Norfolk Island
(d) Paracel Island

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2017

Ans. (b)

Salt Flat or salt pan is a large area of land covered with salt and other minerals and often shines or looks white because of the presence of salt. These are formed in desert and arid areas where large water bodies have dried up over thousands of years leaving behind salt and other remnants. In the given options Saint-Martin Island is a salt pan resource Saint-Martin Island's interior is mostly hilly sloping down to coastal lagoons, salt pans, and sand spits. So, the correct answer would be option (b).

32. Which one of the following countries has the highest number of islands?

- (a) Philippines
(b) Indonesia
(c) Maldives
(d) Cuba
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Indonesia with 17,508 islands has the highest number of islands in the given options, but in the world, Sweden has the highest number of islands.

33. With reference to Socotra Island which of the following statement is/are correct?

1. It is an Island of Oman, situated in the Arabian Sea.
2. It was designated as a World Natural Heritage Site by UNESCO in 2008.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- codes :
(a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

- Socotra or Soqotra, located between the Guardafui Channel and the Arabian Sea, is the largest of four islands in the Socotra Archipelago. The island of Socotra constitutes around 95% of the landmass of the Socotra Archipelago.
- The territory is officially part of it Yemen situated at the mouth of the Gulf of Aden and lies some 240 kilometers east of the coast of Somalia and 380 kilometers south of the Arabian Peninsula.
- It was designated as a World Natural Heritage Site by UNESCO in 2008.

34. Which of the following is the correct sequence of the Islands of Indonesia from West to East?

- (a) Java, Sumatra, Lombok, Bali
(b) Sumatra, Java, Bali, Lombok